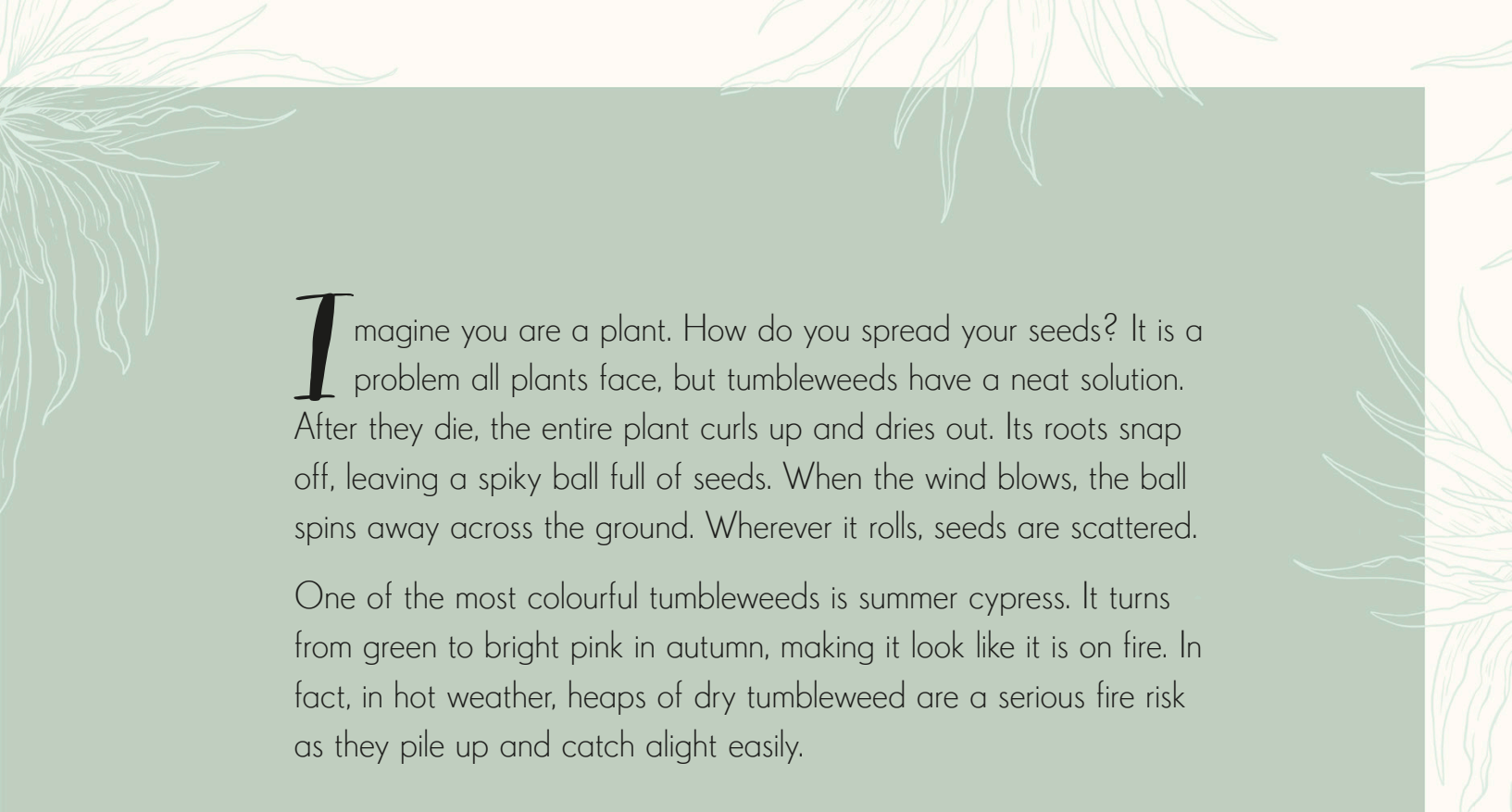




Imagine you are a plant. How do you spread your seeds? It is a problem all plants face, but tumbleweeds have a neat solution. After they die, the entire plant curls up and dries out. Its roots snap off, leaving a spiky ball full of seeds. When the wind blows, the ball spins away across the ground. Wherever it rolls, seeds are scattered.

One of the most colourful tumbleweeds is summer cypress. It turns from green to bright pink in autumn, making it look like it is on fire. In fact, in hot weather, heaps of dry tumbleweed are a serious fire risk as they pile up and catch alight easily.

*In the USA, the wind sweeps tumbleweeds
into great heaps that block roads
and bury whole houses.*

